

Travel & Expense Policy

Company: DT

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1. Travel Eligibility and Approvals

1.1. Who Can Travel

Business travel is permitted for employees whose roles require client meetings, inter-office collaboration, or conference attendance. All travel must be strictly for DT business purposes.

1.2. Approval Requirements

- **Domestic Travel:** Requires written approval (via the Expense Portal) from the direct Manager at least 7 days prior to departure.
- **International Travel:** Requires written approval from the Department Head and the VP of Finance at least 21 days prior to departure.

2. Transportation

2.1. Flights

Employees must book Economy class for all domestic flights. For international flights exceeding 8 hours of continuous flying time, Premium Economy may be booked with Department Head approval. Flights must be booked at least 7 days in advance for domestic and 21 days for international to secure optimal rates.

2.2. Trains

Employees are entitled to travel via 2nd AC (2AC) or 3rd AC (3AC) for domestic rail travel.

2.3. Taxis and Local Transportation

Employees may use ride-hailing apps (Uber, Ola) or pre-paid airport taxis. The maximum allowable reimbursement for airport transfers is ₹1,000 per trip. Daily local travel during the business trip should not exceed ₹800 per day.

2.4. Personal Vehicles

If an employee uses a personal vehicle for inter-city business travel, they may claim mileage at the rate of ₹12 per kilometer. Toll receipts must be provided.

3. Accommodation

Hotel bookings should prioritize safety, proximity to the work location, and cost-effectiveness.

3.1. Reimbursement Limits (Taxes excluded)

- **Tier 1 Cities (e.g., Bangalore, Mumbai, Delhi, Chennai, Hyderabad):** Maximum of ₹6,000 per night.
- **Tier 2/3 Cities:** Maximum of ₹4,000 per night.
- **International Travel:** Limits are dynamically set in the Expense Portal based on the destination city's per diem rates.

3.2. Room Type and Incidentals

Employees must book standard/base category single-occupancy rooms. Expenses for laundry, minibar, spa services, or pay-per-view movies are considered personal and will not be reimbursed.

4. Meals

4.1. Daily Limits

Employees on domestic business travel are granted a daily meal allowance limit of ₹1,500 per day (inclusive of taxes and tips). This is not a per-diem flat payout; employees will only be reimbursed for actual expenses up to this limit based on receipts.

4.2. Alcohol Policy

DT does not reimburse any expenses for alcoholic beverages. Receipts containing alcohol will be rejected entirely unless the alcohol charges are explicitly itemized and excluded from the claim amount.

4.3. Client Meals

If an employee is hosting a client, the daily meal limit does not apply. However, the expense must be pre-approved by the Manager, and the names and companies of the clients hosted must be detailed in the expense claim. Maximum limit per client head is ₹2,500.

5. Expense Claims Process

5.1. Submission Timeline

All expense claims must be submitted via the Finance Portal within 15 days of the travel end date. Claims submitted after 15 days will be automatically rejected.

5.2. Receipt Requirements

Itemized, GST-compliant original receipts are mandatory for any individual expense exceeding ₹500. Credit card statements do not qualify as valid receipts.

5.3. Missing Receipts

If a receipt under ₹500 is lost, the employee must submit a "Missing Receipt Declaration" form. Only three missing receipt declarations are permitted per calendar year per employee.

5.4. Processing Timelines

Approved expenses are processed by the Finance team on the 15th and 30th of every month. Payments will be credited directly to the employee's salary bank account.

6. Important Examples

- **Example 1: Reimbursable Expense**

Scenario: An employee travels to the Chennai office and spends ₹750 on an Uber from the airport, providing the digital receipt.

Rule: Reimbursable. The amount is under the ₹1,000 airport transfer limit, and a receipt was provided.

- **Example 2: Non-Reimbursable Expense**

Scenario: An employee submits a dinner receipt for ₹1,800 while traveling alone in Delhi.

Rule: Not fully reimbursable. The maximum daily meal limit is ₹1,500. Only ₹1,500 will be reimbursed; the remaining ₹300 is an out-of-pocket personal expense.

- **Example 3: Accommodation Limit**

Scenario: An employee spends ₹8,000 on a hotel during a business trip to Hyderabad.

Rule: The claim is reimbursable only up to the Tier 1 accommodation limit of ₹6,000 per night. The extra ₹2,000 will not be reimbursed.

- **Example 4: Missing Receipt**

Scenario: An employee submits an expense for a ₹600 train ticket without a receipt, using their first Missing Receipt Declaration.

Rule: Rejected. Missing receipt declarations are only valid for expenses strictly under ₹500. The claim is void.